

Rocuronium

(Zemuron)

I. Classification

- Neuromuscular Blocker Agent, Nondepolarizing

II. Actions

- Blocks acetylcholine from attaching to neuromuscular receptor which inhibits their depolarization

III. Indications

- For muscle paralysis in Delayed Sequence Intubation

IV. Contraindications

- Allergy to drug or to similar classes of drugs

V. Precautions

- Class C in Pregnancy
- Cardiovascular disease may cause delay in onset or prolonged paralysis
- Clinical duration may be prolonged in liver failure
- Use with caution in elderly, effects are variable
- Immobilized patients may have resistance to medication

VI. Drug Interactions

- Several medications have moderate interaction, monitor for increase effect of neuromuscular blockade
- Corticosteroids – may enhance the neuromuscular effects of corticosteroids, consider alternative neuromuscular blockade if feasible
- Quinine – avoid combination due to increased neuromuscular blockade

VII. Adult dosing and administration

- 0.6 mg/kg (max dose 100mg) IV/IO

VIII. Pediatric dosing and administration:

- Pediatric doses will only be used if patient is intubated and sedated by hospital staff and patient requires further paralysis due to ventilation complications
- ENSURE ADEQUATE SEDATION PRIOR TO CONSIDERING PARALYTIC
- 0.6 mg/kg (max dose 100mg) IV/IO in children > 1 year old

IX. Onset

- 1-2 minutes for intubation, max blockade at 4 minutes

X. Duration

- 30 minutes

XI. Possible adverse effects

- Apnea
- Respiratory depression
- May cause hyper or hypotension

XII. Notes

- ** Has NO effect on level of consciousness
- ** Has NO pain control properties
- ** Anaphylactic reactions may occur. Have epinephrine readily available.